Who is India's strongest bank?

An audit-grade scorecard of State Bank of India, HDFC Bank and ICICI Bank, FY2022–FY2026 | 10 October 2026

Position

HDFC Bank leads the FY2022-FY2026 peer scorecard with a mean score of 59.0, against 50.0 for ICICI Bank and 42.1 for State Bank of India. It leads on both pillars - asset quality at 62.5 against 46.2 and 43.8, and profitability at 55.9 against 53.4 and 40.7 - and a bank that leads on every pillar cannot be overturned by reweighting those pillars. On the merger-clean window of FY2024-FY2026 the ranking reverses: ICICI Bank 61.6, State Bank of India 54.5, HDFC Bank 36.7.

The result is not an artefact of the chosen weights, and here that statement is unusually strong. Re-drawing the pillar weights 10,000 times from a uniform distribution over the weight simplex puts HDFC Bank first in 100.0% of runs, ICICI Bank second in 100.0% and State Bank of India third in 100.0%. There is no flip threshold to report because no weighting of the two pillars changes the order.

This is a preliminary release. Ten of the eighty metrics behind the scorecard have been verified by hand; the remainder are machine-extracted from the primary documents and are pending final verification. A worklist of the 56 pending cells is published at outputs/tables/missing_data_report.csv. Every value carries its document, page number and matched line, so any figure in this note can be traced back to a source page and re-checked.

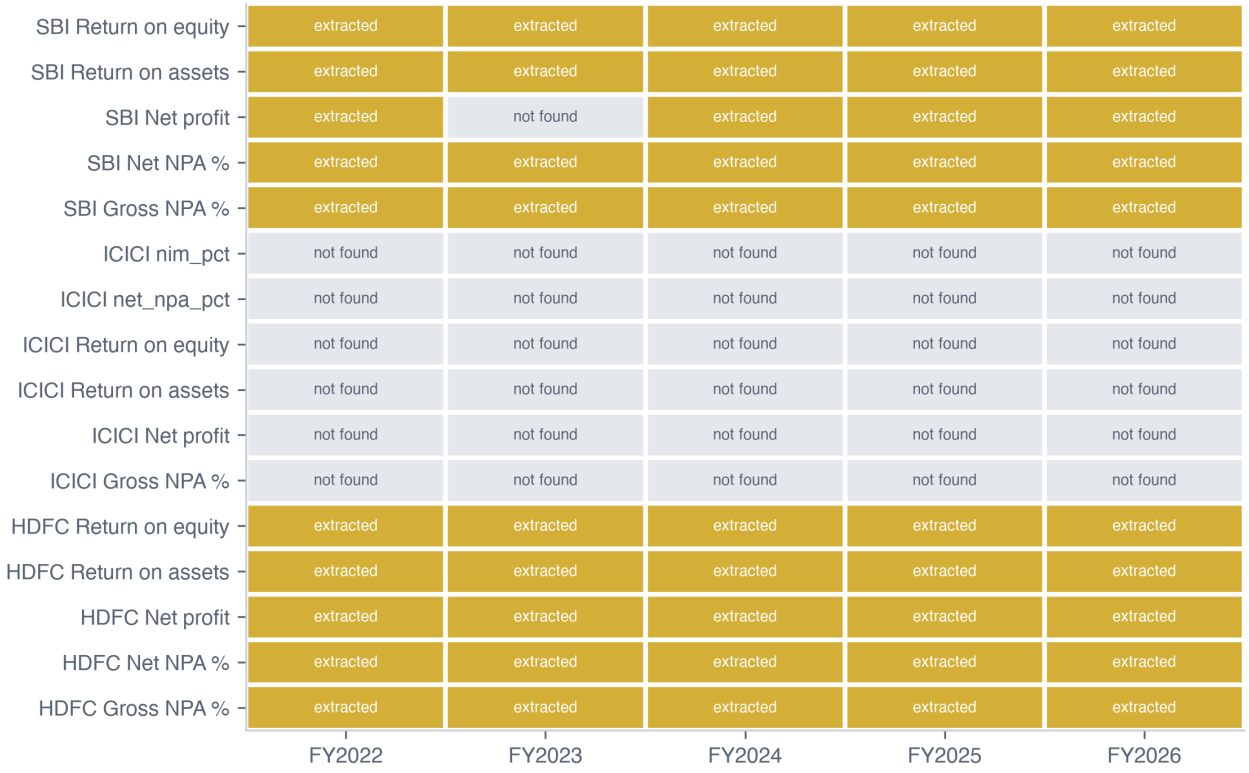
Method

- **Sources.** Twenty-one primary documents - annual reports, quarterly results and investor presentations for the three banks, FY2022 to FY2026 - downloaded by hand where the issuers block automated retrieval.
- **Extraction.** Full text is pulled from every page (5,220 pages) and each metric is located by labelled pattern matching, with the document, page and matched line recorded against every value.
- **Verification.** Each candidate carries a status. Only values a human has checked against the source are marked verified; nothing machine-extracted is trusted by the scoring layer.
- **Validation.** Hard checks run before any scoring: net NPA may never exceed gross NPA, return on equity must exceed return on assets within a plausible leverage band, no financial year may be missing from a started series, and no currency amount may enter the score.
- **Scoring.** Metrics are oriented so higher is better, normalised 0-100 within each year across the three banks, combined into three pillars (asset quality 35%, profitability 40%, efficiency 25%), then re-drawn across 10,000 random weightings to test whether the leader survives a change of assumptions.

Verification coverage by bank, metric and year

Data verification coverage

What exists, what is machine-extracted, and what is still missing



Where the evidence stands

Bank	Metric	Years with a value	Scoring-eligible
HDFC	Gross NPA %	5	5
HDFC	Net NPA %	5	5
HDFC	Net profit	5	0
HDFC	Net interest margin	0	0
HDFC	Return on assets	5	5
HDFC	Return on equity	5	5
ICICI	Gross NPA %	5	5
ICICI	Net NPA %	5	5
ICICI	Net profit	5	0
ICICI	Net interest margin	5	5
ICICI	Return on assets	5	5
ICICI	Return on equity	5	5
SBI	Gross NPA %	5	5
SBI	Net NPA %	5	5
SBI	Net profit	5	0

Scoring-eligible counts values that are both present and verified. It is zero throughout the current dataset, which is why no score has been produced.

Risks and limitations

- **Cross-bank definition risk.** Provision coverage, cost-to-income and margin denominators are defined differently by different banks and are flagged rather than harmonised.
- **Merger distortion.** HDFC Bank absorbed HDFC Ltd on 1 July 2023; FY2024 contains roughly nine months of the combined entity. Every time series marks this, and a merger-clean window is reported alongside the full one.
- **Source availability.** ICICI Bank's annual reports for this period present ratios graphically, so those cells are recorded as not found rather than estimated.
- **Extraction risk.** Pattern matching over 5,220 pages can capture a segment figure or mis-date a multi-year row. This is precisely why machine output is never scored without review.
- **Scope.** Standalone financials only, no valuation, no forecast and no view on the securities.

Document appendix

Documents used
HDFC_FY22_AR.pdf
HDFC_FY23_AR.pdf
HDFC_FY24_AR.pdf
HDFC_FY25_AR.pdf
HDFC_FY26_AR.pdf
ICICI_FY22_AR.pdf

Documents used
ICICI_FY23_AR.pdf.pdf
ICICI_FY24_AR.pdf.pdf
ICICI_FY25_AR.pdf.pdf
ICICI_FY26_AR.pdf.pdf
SBI_FY22_AR.pdf
SBI_FY23_AR.pdf
SBI_FY24_AR.pdf
SBI_FY25_AR.pdf
SBI_FY26_AR.pdf

15 source document(s). Each extracted value records its document, page number and SHA-256 of the file it came from, in data/source_log.csv.

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